RAJASTHANI COLLECTION

NO. 09



RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Mangodi Ki Sabzi

Sun-Dried Lentil Dumpling Curry

Preserved Protein for the Desert Pantry

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Mangodi Ki Sabzi

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Mangodi Ki Sabzi

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Sunshine Turned into a Pantry Staple

Mangodi — small, sun-dried dumplings made from ground moong dal (and sometimes urad dal), shaped and dried in the sun over several days — represent one of Rajasthan's most practical solutions to the challenge of preserving protein without refrigeration. The process itself is seasonal and labor-intensive: a thick lentil paste is piped or shaped into small nuggets and spread out to dry under the intense desert sun, traditionally during the hottest, driest months when the process works most reliably.

Once dried, mangodi keep for months in an airtight container, ready to be rehydrated and cooked into a curry whenever fresh vegetables aren't available — a near-identical philosophy to Bihar's bari, featured elsewhere in this cookbook series, though Rajasthani mangodi are typically smaller and often used specifically in this standalone curry rather than primarily in a kadhi.

Making mangodi at home remains a seasonal ritual in many Rajasthani households, particularly among families with rural roots, though store-bought versions have become increasingly common and convenient for city dwellers and cooks outside Rajasthan wanting to recreate the dish without dedicating several sunny days to drying their own batch.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Sunshine Turned into a Pantry Staple, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Represents a Rajasthani solution to preserving lentil-based protein without refrigeration, closely related to Bihar's bari featured elsewhere in this cookbook series. Traditionally made as a seasonal household ritual, sun-dried over several days during Rajasthan's hottest, driest months. Once dried, mangodi keep for months, providing reliable protein and substance regardless of vegetable availability. Increasingly available store-bought, making the dish more accessible to cooks without the time or climate for traditional sun-drying.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

15m	30m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Mangodi ki sabzi keeps refrigerated for up to 4 days and, like most dumpling curries, tastes good reheated. It freezes well for up to 2 months. Dried, unsoaked mangodi themselves keep for months in an airtight container.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the mangodi (or store-bought)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Store-bought dried mangodi	1 cup	100 g	1 katori

For the curry

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Onion, finely chopped	1 medium	100 g	1 medium
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Tomato, pureed	2 medium	200 g	2 medium
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Water	1½ cups	360 ml	1½ katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Dried mangodi are available at Indian grocers, particularly those serving a Rajasthani clientele, sometimes labeled "mangodi" or "moong dal vadi"; Bihar's bari, featured elsewhere in this cookbook series, is a close and workable substitute if mangodi specifically isn't available. This dish otherwise uses common pantry ingredients accessible worldwide.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Preparing the Mangodi

01 FRY THE MANGODI

Heat a little oil in a kadai and lightly fry the dried mangodi for 3–4 minutes, until golden — this step firms them up and deepens their flavor before they go into the curry.



Chef tip. frying rather than boiling the mangodi first gives a deeper, nuttier flavor that holds up well in the simmering gravy.

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Preparing the Mangodi, continued

02 SET ASIDE

Remove the fried mangodi and set aside while you build the curry base.

> **COOKING CHECKPOINT**
>
> The mangodi should turn golden-brown and firm, not burnt, before being set aside for the gravy.

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Building the Curry

03 TEMPER AND SAUTÉ

In the same kadai, add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle. Add the chopped onion and cook until golden, about 6–7 minutes.

04 ADD AROMATICS AND TOMATO

Stir in the ginger-garlic paste, cooking until fragrant, then add the tomato puree, turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder. Simmer for 8–10 minutes, until thickened and the oil separates slightly.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Curry, continued

05 ADD WATER AND THE MANGODI

Add the water and salt, bring to a simmer, then add the fried mangodi. Simmer for 12–15 minutes, until the mangodi soften and absorb the gravy while still holding their shape.

Texture indicator. mangodi should be tender but still distinctly chewy, having absorbed the gravy's flavor without disintegrating.

06 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Skipping the initial frying step and adding dried mangodi directly to the gravy results in a less developed flavor and can leave them undercooked at the center. Always fry first.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with roti or rice, a reliable pantry-based Rajasthani meal.
- A practical dish for periods when fresh vegetables aren't readily available.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A hearty, protein-rich curry alongside simple bread or rice for a complete meal.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Frying the mangodi before adding them to the gravy is essential for both flavor and proper texture.
- A well-developed onion-tomato base gives the curry real depth that pairs well with the mangodi's nutty, chewy character.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Dried mangodi keep for months, making this a genuinely convenient pantry-based dish for busy periods.
- The curry itself reheats well, making it practical for meal prep across a busy week.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some Rajasthani cooks add a small amount of kasuri methi to the gravy for extra aroma, a technique that pairs particularly well with the mangodi's earthy flavor.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

220 kcal	10 g	20 g	12 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Classic Mangodi Ki Sabzi	the tomato-based version featured here.
Mangodi Ki Kadhi	mangodi added to a yogurt-based kadhi instead of a tomato gravy.
Dry Mangodi Sabzi	a less saucy version with mangodi tossed in a drier spice mixture.

Where can I buy mangodi?

Indian grocers serving a Rajasthani or North Indian clientele often stock them, sometimes labeled "mangodi" or "moong dal vadi"; Bihar's bari is a close substitute if unavailable.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make mangodi at home?

Yes, traditionally by shaping a thick moong dal paste into small nuggets and sun-drying over several days, though this requires consistent hot, dry weather.

Is this dish similar to any other in this cookbook series?

Yes — it's technically very similar to Bihar's kadhi bari, both using sun-dried lentil dumplings, though the specific curry base and regional spicing differ.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Mangodi	small, sun-dried moong dal dumplings, the centerpiece of this dish.
Bari	a related North Indian and Bihari dried lentil dumpling, a close substitute for mangodi.
Moong Dal	split, skinned yellow lentil, the base ingredient for mangodi.
Tadka	a tempering of spices bloomed in hot oil, foundational to this dish's flavor.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Mangodi Ki Sabzi

15m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

MANGODI (OR STORE-BOUGHT)

Store-bought dried mangodi	100 g

CURRY

Oil	45 ml
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Onion	100 g
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Tomato	200 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	3 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Water	360 ml
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Fry the mangodi.** Heat a little oil in a kadai and lightly fry the dried mangodi for 3–4 minutes, until golden — this step firms them up and deepens their flavor before they go into the curry.

02 **Set aside.** Remove the fried mangodi and set aside while you build the curry base.

03 **Temper and sauté.** In the same kadai, add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle.

04 **Add aromatics and tomato.** Stir in the ginger-garlic paste, cooking until fragrant, then add the tomato puree, turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder.

05 **Add water and the mangodi.** Add the water and salt, bring to a simmer, then add the fried mangodi.

06 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Store-bought dried mangodi	100 g	☐ Oil	45 ml
☐ Cumin seeds	4 g	☐ Asafoetida	pinch
☐ Onion	100 g	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Tomato	200 g	☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g
☐ Red chili powder	3 g	☐ Coriander powder	3 g
☐ Salt	6 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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